Cocent

Every cent, with your consent.

An AI finance copilot for small businesses

Fintechathon 2026 · International Track · Topic E: SME Finance Copilot · Team Cocent: M. Rayaan Ali and M. Hasaan Ali

A QUICK QUESTION

A supplier emails: “We’ve changed banks. Please pay our new account today.”

Would you pay?

THE PROBLEM

Sarah runs a bakery, not a finance team

Six staff in Leeds, supplying local cafés. She does the books in the evenings.

- Bills arrive by email
- Customers pay through a payment platform
- Money sits in one business bank account
- Accounting software: maybe, maybe not

“Where does my cash stand?”

Spread across inbox, bank and payments, with no view of next month

“Who still owes me?”

Late payers are noticed when the money is already short

“Is this bill real?”

A changed bank detail looks like any other email

THE EVIDENCE

It isn’t just Sarah

82%

of UK SMEs have had cash-flow problems, 7.4 times a year on average

Novuna Business Cash Flow, Dec 2025

62%

of UK small businesses surveyed are owed money on unpaid invoices

QuickBooks UK Late Payments Report 2025

80%

of invoice and bank-detail scam cases in 2023 started with an email

UK Finance Annual Fraud Report 2024

THE COST

What it costs owners like Sarah

11 hours

a week on admin and finance: about six working days a month

American Express SME Business Barometer, Jul 2026

36%

name late customer payments as the most common cause of cash problems

Novuna Business Cash Flow, Dec 2025

£41.3m

lost in the UK in 2025 to invoice and mandate scams: fake invoices and new bank details

UK Finance Annual Fraud Report 2026

THE SOLUTION

Cocent does the work and asks before it acts

Bills in, no typing

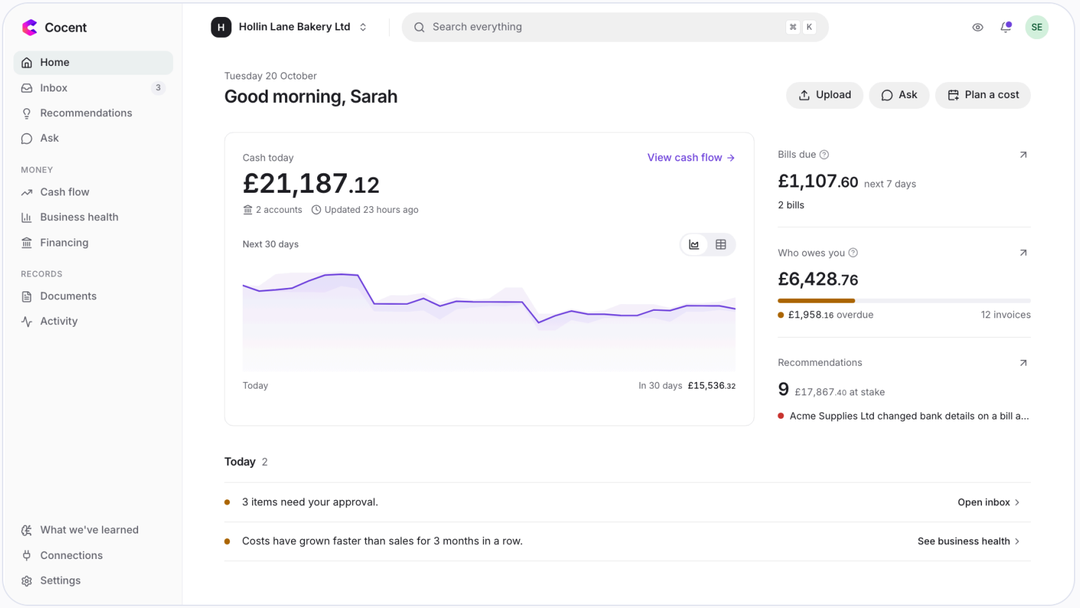
Read from the inbox they already arrive in, then added to the books with the original attached

Cash ahead

A 90-day forecast, a warning before cash runs short, and financing that fits

Safe by design

Nothing happens without approval, and private details never reach the AI



LIVE DEMO

A week at the bakery, in six steps

1 · First

The fraud email is caught

New bank details flagged; two people must approve

2

A real bill arrives

Private details hidden before the AI reads it

3

One tap to approve

Added to the books with the original attached

4

Try a cost first

A new oven tried on the forecast before Sarah commits

5

Cash ahead

A shortfall warned weeks early, with financing that fits

6

Every step logged

A tamper-evident record of who did what

BEFORE AND AFTER

Sarah’s week, before and with Cocent

Task	Before	With Cocent
A bill reaches the books	Retyped by hand, PDF filed separately	Read and checked in 6–11 seconds; once approved, added with the original attached
Matching bank to bills	Line by line, by hand	146 payments linked on the first read; a person confirms the rest
Next month’s cash	A spreadsheet, if anyone makes one	A 90-day forecast, always up to date
“New bank details”	Often paid without checking	Flagged; two people must approve

SECURITY AND COMPLIANCE

The AI suggests. People decide.

Approval levels

Every action has a fixed level; changing a supplier’s bank details needs two different people

Private details hidden

Names, accounts and card numbers replaced before the AI sees text; a second check blocks anything left

Tamper-evident log

Every step chained to the last, so any change to the record shows

Least access

Two-step sign-in for owners and finance managers, four roles, and calls only to a fixed list of services

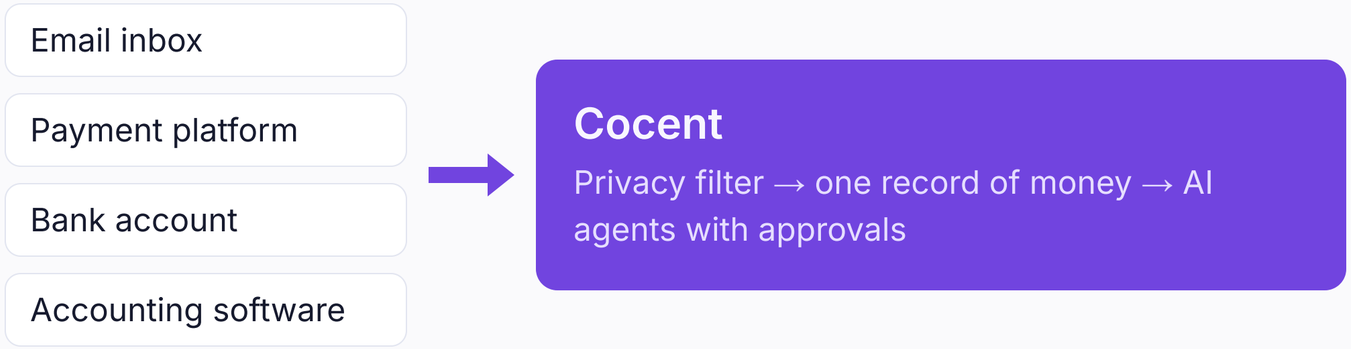
TEAM AND BUILD

Who built it, and how

Team Cocent

M. Rayaan Ali
Team leader

M. Hasaan Ali
Team member



Tested against real sandbox services, not mock data. Over 700 automated tests (568 server, 180 app, 7 browser journeys) and 14 live sandbox checks, with a regression test for every bug we fixed.

Cocent

Every cent, with your consent.

Thank you. Questions welcome.

github.com/Rayaan-office/cocent-sme-finance-copilot